

Monday, 17 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

26° 20°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

26° 17°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

22° 16°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

18° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

People who fled Stourbridge fires start to return home.

Many families are only just discovering the extent of damage to their homes for the first time.

UK · NEWS

2

Soldiers praised for 'phenomenal job' helping crews tackle wildfires.

About 200 members of the Queen's Own Gurkha Logistic Regiment have been involved in the operation.

UK · NEWS

3

Ariana Grande leaves problems at home as her tour hits the UK.

The star plays the first of 10 dates in London, after which she will "step back" from public life.

UK · NEWS

4

Unauthorised sites are growing but travellers say they are forced to break the law.

The government says such developments are unacceptable – so why do they keep springing up?

UK · NEWS

5

Britain's youngest Formula E driver says talent isn't enough anymore.

Taylor Barnard, 22, says talented young drivers often get shut out because of financial issues.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

1

Thousands of Bonnie Tyler fans line the streets as coffin taken to Swansea home.

The Total Eclipse of the Heart singer died last month in a hospital in Portugal.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Secondhand book sales are booming. Is it because of AI?.

Booksellers are reporting mysterious bulk orders. It's thought the books are being used to train AI - and ending up pulped.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

BBC seeks to subpoena family members in Panorama lawsuit.

A spokesperson for Trump's legal team responded to the request accusing the broadcaster of "seeking to harass" the president's family.

SHOWBIZ · UK

4

Stephen Bear jailed over sex offender breaches.

The TV personality posted in Brazil "the police will not be able to catch" him, a court hears.

SHOWBIZ · UK

5

The Office's Lucy Davis 'overwhelmed' by kindness after cancer diagnosis.

The Office actress thanks well-wishers for their support after she revealed she had incurable cancer.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Donnelly wins GB's first women's marathon medal at Europeans.**
Abbie Donnelly became the first British woman to win a marathon medal at the European Championships as she claimed bronze in Birmingham on Sunday.

SPORT · UK

- 2 Elvedi set for Leeds move as £8.5m fee agreed.**
Leeds agree an £8.5m deal to sign defender Nico Elvedi, who is set to have a medical on Monday.

SPORT · UK

- 3 Medal ceremonies postponed at Europeans after fraud arrest.**
Transport was also delayed because of the arrest, leading to crowds building up outside the venue.

SPORT · UK

- 4 What has been the impact of new owners on The Hundred?.**
BBC Sport looks at the impact new owners have had on The Hundred as the first season since private stakes were sold in teams draws to a close.

SPORT · UK

- 5 Coventry agree deal for Forest striker Awoniyi.**
Coventry City agree a deal worth about £17m for Nottingham Forest striker Taiwo Awoniyi.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that 'power napping' can significantly boost creativity and problem-solving skills.**
Researchers found that even a short 20-minute snooze can help reset the brain, leading to fresh perspectives on challenges. So, don't feel guilty about that midday doze!
- 2 The delightful art of 'upcycling old furniture' is gaining traction, with more people transforming pre-loved pieces into stylish home additions.**
It's a wonderful way to be sustainable and add a unique, personal touch to your living space, saving items from landfill and sparking creativity.
- 3 A quirky trend sees pet owners creating 'gourmet meals' for their furry friends, moving beyond traditional kibble.**
From homemade stews to specially baked treats, our four-legged companions are certainly living the high life with these culinary creations!
- 4 New research indicates that simply 'looking at photos of cute animals' can reduce stress and improve focus.**
Scientists found that participants felt calmer and performed better on tasks after a quick dose of adorable animal imagery. Time for a puppy break!
- 5 The charming pastime of 'letter writing' is experiencing a quiet revival, with more people sending handwritten notes.**
There's something wonderfully personal and enduring about receiving a proper letter in the post, a lovely change from emails and texts.
- 6 A fascinating study reveals that 'listening to classical music' while doing chores can make tasks feel less mundane.**
Experts suggest that the harmonious melodies can distract the brain from the repetitiveness of household tasks, making them surprisingly enjoyable.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'building a jigsaw puzzle' is making a heartwarming comeback as a mindful leisure activity.**
Families and individuals are rediscovering the satisfaction of piecing together images, finding it a relaxing and engaging way to unwind.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're tidying up, even though we know we should probably put things away properly?

ANSWER: SHOVING THINGS INTO A 'TIDYING CUPBOARD' OR DRAWER, HOPING NO ONE LOOKS INSIDE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT 'ANTICLOCKWISE' THREE TIMES, THEN CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES, 'FOR GOOD LUCK'!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'secret shortcut' in your local area that saves you loads of time, or helps you avoid traffic?**

Have you got a brilliant, lesser-known route or pathway you've stumbled upon that you'd be willing to share with us, or perhaps a clever hack for navigating your daily routine?

- **We all have those 'childhood games' or playground activities that we absolutely adored, don't we, that perhaps don't get played much anymore?**

What was your absolute favourite game to play as a child, perhaps one that involved skipping rhymes, chasing, or imaginative adventures? Tell us how you played it!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat, particularly brine shrimp and algae, which contain a natural pink pigment?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called an 'array'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a group of berries that have fused together.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from outer space.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one-hundredth of a second.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The British Isles are home to over 1,500 different species of spiders, most of which are harmless.

On this day

Day 229 of the year, 136 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Saint Beatrice of Silva; Christian feast day: Saint Clare of Montefalco; Christian feast day: Elias of Enna; Christian feast day: Saint Hyacinth of Poland. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1982 — Mark Salling, American actor and musician (died 2018)
- 1954 — Eric Johnson, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1988 — Joyner Lucas, American rapper
- 1991 — Austin Butler, American actor
- 1950 — Geraint Jarman, Welsh musician, poet and television producer (died 2025)
- 1958 — Belinda Carlisle, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Kelvin Mercer, American rapper, songwriter and producer
- 1934 — Ron Henry, English footballer (died 2014)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2005 — The first forced evacuation of settlers, as part of Israeli disengagement from Gaza, starts.
- 1970 — Soviet Union Venera program: Venera 7 launched. It will become the first spacecraft to successfully transmit data from the surface of another planet (Venus).
- 1977 — The Soviet icebreaker Arktika becomes the first surface ship to reach the North Pole.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — The National Assembly of Serbia unanimously adopts new state symbols for Serbia: Bože pravde becomes the new anthem and the coat of arms is adopted for the whole country.
- 1959 — Quake Lake is formed by the magnitude 7.2 1959 Hebgen Lake earthquake near Hebgen Lake in Montana.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — American swimmer Michael Phelps becomes the first person to win eight gold medals at one Olympic Games.
- 2005 — Over 500 bombs are set off by terrorists at 300 locations in 63 out of the 64 districts of Bangladesh.

- 2017 — Barcelona attacks: A van is driven into pedestrians in La Rambla, killing 14 and injuring at least 100.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 230 of the year, 135 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Agapitus of Palestrina; Christian feast day: Alberto Hurtado; Christian feast day: Daig of Inniskeen; Christian feast day: Evan (or Inan). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — Patrick Swayze, American actor and dancer (died 2009)
- 1969 — Masta Killa, American rapper
- 1957 — Denis Leary, American comedian, actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1957 — Tan Dun, Chinese composer
- 1995 — Parker McKenna Posey, American actress
- 1962 — Adam Storke, American actor
- 1939 — Maxine Brown, American soul/R&B singer-songwriter
- 1945 — Sarah Dash, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 2021)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2008 — The President of Pakistan, Pervez Musharraf, resigns under threat of impeachment.
- 1945 — Sukarno takes office as the first president of Indonesia, following the country's declaration of independence the previous day.
- 1989 — Leading presidential hopeful Luis Carlos Galán is assassinated near Bogotá in Colombia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2003 — One-year-old Zachary Turner is murdered in Newfoundland by his mother, who was awarded custody despite facing trial for the murder of Zachary's father. The case was documented in the film Dear Zachary and led to reform of Canada's bail laws.
- 1966 — Vietnam War: The Battle of Long Tan ensues after a patrol from the 6th Battalion, Royal Australian Regiment clashes with a Viet Cong force in Phước Tuy Province.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)